

Left (top to bottom) A classic diner snack – French fries and a strawberry milk shake; a typical US diner in San Francisco; syrup and butter over waffles, with fresh fruit on the side

Below (top to bottom) Red Formica tables, checker-patterned plates, and jukeboxes help create the retro-diner look; Ed's Easy Diner, in Soho, London, is a haven for exhausted shoppers



ENGLAND

It's not surprising that London, with its fashionable restaurants and love of quirky style, embraced the retro diner craze, but now shiny silver American-style diners are springing up in the rest of the country too.

Ed's Easy Diner inexpensive

12 Moor St., London W1; www.edseasydiner.com

The all-day breakfast, juicy burgers, and creamy shakes are a hit at this colorful diner with a prime corner spot in Soho. Hot pepper addicts will love the "atomic" American fries and onion rings. Grab a red swivel chair at the shiny chrome counter.

Good Life Diner inexpensive

128–130 Curtain Rd., Shoreditch, London EC2; www.goodlifediner.com

Leather booths, lots of neon, and a '50s soundtrack form the backdrop to the burgers at this trendy American diner, which has four other London locations, in Camden, Islington, Soho, and Kensal Rise.

The 50s American Diner moderate

John St., Church Gresley, Derbyshire; www.the50samericandiner.bravehost.com

Burgers, steaks, and hot diggity dogs are served in this authentic, gleaming steel O'Mahony diner, shipped over from Boston to the National Forest in Derbyshire and filled with '50s memorabilia. Friendly waitresses wear vintage dresses to serve up food in four-seater booths and the jukebox plays rock 'n' roll.

IRELAND

With their long connections to America, it's no wonder that the fun-loving Irish have taken classic American burgers, shakes, and diner dishes along with 1950s nostalgia into their hearts, and opened some great diners.

Eddie Rocket's inexpensive

7 South Anne St., Dublin; www.eddirockets.ie

Fresh-ground burgers, foot-long hot dogs, red-basket specials, and hand-dipped Shake Shop malts come with a huge helping of '50s attitude. There are 20 Eddie Rocket's diners in greater Dublin and more around the country.

Springsteen's Diner moderate

633 Lisburn Rd., Belfast; www.springsteensdiner.com

With its flashy neon jukebox, all-day breakfasts, Whitehouse burgers (named after US presidents), and big menu of American favorites, this characterful diner could have been born in the USA.

REST OF EUROPE

Retro diners have crossed over to the Continent too. Paris may be the preserve of French culture and cuisine, but even here the stylish appeal of old-style American diners flourishes on the Left Bank.

Breakfast in America inexpensive

17 rue des Ecoles, Paris, France; www.breakfast-in-america.com

An ex-pat American filmmaker, longing for a stack of pancakes and a "bottomless mug o' Joe," opened this popular diner serving tasty all-day breakfasts, burgers, and blue *plat du jour*.

Happy Days Diner inexpensive

25 rue Francisque Gay, Paris, France; www.happydaysdiner.com

Enjoy mega-burgers, Long Island bagels, milk shakes, and more along with rockabilly music and a '50s ambience at this cheery diner sporting turquoise booths and pastel-pink countertops.

Flamme und Feuer moderate

Klein Breitenbach 2, Mörlenbach, near Mannheim, Germany; www.flammeundfeuer.de

Flamme und Feuer ("Flame and Fire") has a long American menu, but it's the all-you-can-eat burger and spare-rib nights and breakfast buffets that draw the Harley- and classic car-loving crowds.

AUSTRALIA

American diners seem completely at home in the land of road trains and beach barbies, especially in the cities, where the 1950s memorabilia, rock 'n' roll music, and diner fare add up to a really fun place to meet.

Big Rig Diner moderate

231 Oxford St., Darlinghurst, New South Wales; + 61 2 9332 3197

Tasty burgers, homemade chili, and other American favorites come with a big dollop of '50s style amid Elvis posters and great music on the jukebox. Check out the Houndstooth Bar at the back.

Misty's Diner moderate–expensive

103–105 High St., Prahran, Victoria; www.mistysdiner.com.au

Misty hails from Phoenix, Arizona, and her Aussie diner serves fare with a Southern flair, from deep-fried pickles and corn dogs to a bucket of pork ribs or "trailer-trash" fried steak. Misty's motto: "Bring your appetite, it's gonna get messy."